

AGREEMENT

between

**THE BOARD OF EDUCATION
OF SCHOOL DISTRICT NO. 65
EVANSTON, ILLINOIS**

and

**EVANSTON TEACHER ASSISTANTS ASSOCIATION
ILLINOIS EDUCATION ASSOCIATION - NEA
FOR
SCHOOL YEARS 2025-2026, 2026-2027, 2027-2028 and 2028-2029**

TABLE OF CONTENTS

	<u>PAGE</u>
ARTICLE 1	1
ARTICLE 2	2
ARTICLE 3	3
ARTICLE 4	6
ARTICLE 5	9
ARTICLE 6	11
ARTICLE 7	12
ARTICLE 8	14
ARTICLE 9	18
ARTICLE 10	19
ARTICLE 11	20
ARTICLE 12	26
ARTICLE 13	28
ARTICLE 14	30
ARTICLE 15	37
ARTICLE 16	38
APPENDIX A-1	39

ARTICLE 1
RECOGNITION

The Board of Education of Evanston/Skokie Community Consolidated School District 65, Cook County, Illinois (hereinafter the “District”), hereby recognizes the Evanston Teacher Assistants Association, Illinois Education Association-NEA (hereinafter “ETAA” or the “Association”), as the sole and exclusive bargaining representative for all paraprofessionals employed by the District. Such representation shall exclude all managerial, administrative, and supervisory employees of the District. “Bargaining unit member,” “employee,” or “paraprofessional” when used hereinafter in this Agreement shall refer to all employees represented by the ETAA, IEA-NEA, in the bargaining unit as above defined. The term “District” or “employer” when used hereinafter in this Agreement shall refer to the Board of Education of Evanston/Skokie Community Consolidated School District 65 or its administrative or supervisory personnel.

ARTICLE 2
DUES DEDUCTION

- A. Any member of the bargaining unit who is a member or has applied for membership in the Association may sign and deliver to the District a written authorization for continuous or annual dues deduction. The appropriate authorization forms shall be provided by the Association. The continuous authorization shall remain in effect from year to year unless the employee revokes said authorization in writing.
- B. The District shall deduct from each employee's pay the current dues of the Association provided the District has received an official notification of the dues amount or increase thereof. Pursuant to such authorization, the District shall deduct such dues from the regular salary check of the bargaining unit member each month beginning in October and ending in June of each year. The District shall remit said deducted dues to the Association within fifteen (15) days following the pay period deduction. The District shall deduct the dues authorized for those employees who are employed after the commencement of the school year in as equal installments as possible to insure the proper dues are deducted for those employees by June of the school year.

ARTICLE 3
EMPLOYEE AND ASSOCIATION RIGHTS

A. **Notice of Board Meetings**

When practicable, the president of the Association or the president's designee shall be given written notice of all regular and special meetings of the Board together with a copy of the agenda or statement of purpose of each meeting at least twenty-four (24) hours prior to the scheduled time of the meeting. In keeping with Board policy, the Association president or designee shall be given the opportunity to express the Association's views and make recommendations to the Administration or Board on issues which impact paraprofessionals.

B. **Official Board Minutes**

One (1) copy of all Board minutes shall be emailed to the Association President within three (3) days after they are posted on the District's website.

C. **New Employees**

Names and addresses of newly hired bargaining unit employees shall be provided to the Association President within the first week of each new trimester. Further an updated list of the names and addresses of all bargaining unit employees will be sent to the Association President by October 1 of each year. The District will notify the Association of bargaining unit employment terminations, upon request, and by December 15 and July 1 of each year.

D. **Meetings on District Property**

The Association and its representatives shall have the right to hold a reasonable number of official meetings per year on District property, related to the Association's role as bargaining agent for bargaining unit employees, provided that such meetings in no way interfere with District use of said property and provided that when special, custodial service is required, the Association will reimburse the District for the cost of same.

E. **Use of Facilities**

The Association and its representatives shall have the right to use District telephones for non-toll calls only, typewriters, calculators, audio visual and duplicating equipment, and computers with advance notice to the appropriate Administrator, to the extent that such use pertains to the Associations' role as bargaining agent for bargaining unit employees, provided that such use in no way interferes with District use of said equipment, and

provided that the Association will reimburse the District for any additional costs related to the Association's use of this equipment.

F. Association Bulletin Board Space

The Association shall have the right to post notices of activities and matters of Association concern on an Association-supplied bulletin board for support staff, of reasonable size, to be located at each worksite. The Association may use the District mail service and employee mail boxes, in keeping with Board policy, for a reasonable volume of materials pertaining to the Association's representation of bargaining unit employees.

G. Staff Directory

All bargaining unit employees shall be listed in the Staff Directory which is prepared annually by the District by the end of the first semester.

H. Authorized Agreement-Copies

Upon completion of negotiations, an authorized agreement shall be signed by the Board of Education President and the President of ETAA. A copy of this agreement will be distributed to all employees, including employees upon initial hire. The cost of providing these copies shall be borne equally by the District and ETAA.

I. Official Association Business

The District will permit employees from the bargaining unit to be absent from work without loss of pay for up to a maximum total for the entire bargaining unit of fifteen (15) days per school year for official Association business on the following conditions:

1. The Association shall reimburse the District for the cost of substitute(s) if employed;
2. The Association President shall deliver to the Superintendent written notification of the leave at least ten (10) calendar days (and make every reasonable effort to do so at least fourteen (14) calendar days) in advance of the commencement of the leave; and
3. No more than four (4) employees shall be on such leave at the same time.

J. Employee Indemnification

The Board shall agree to indemnify and protect paraprofessionals against death and bodily injury and property damages claims and suits, including defense thereof, when damages are sought for negligent and wrongful acts allegedly committed during the scope of employment or under the direction of the Board.

There shall be no deduction in salary for time lost as a result of legal or administrative proceedings held pursuant to the Board's commitments for indemnification and defense in this section.

K. Complaint Against Employee

Any complaint deemed by any administrator or Board member to justify investigation and or disciplinary action shall be brought to the attention of the employee involved within five (5) working days. Except in cases of extreme emotional instability or alleged criminal action, when the safety and health of the pupils and/or other person(s) are in jeopardy, no action shall be taken until such information has been supplied to the employee.

L. Student Medication

Under no circumstances will employees be required to administer medication to students' however, those employees who voluntarily administer medication or provide emergency assistance to students within the scope of their employment will be indemnified as provided in Article II, Section J. of this Agreement.

M. Information Requests

When the Association requests information from the District which the Association needs in order to intelligently perform its function as bargaining representative for the bargaining unit employees, and which the District is required to furnish under the Illinois Educational Labor Relations Act, the District will provide such information as soon as it is practicable to do so.

N. Bi-Monthly Labor/Management Meetings

The parties agree to hold two (2) meetings per calendar year. The Association and Administration shall select up to four (4) employees to participate.

ARTICLE 4
EMPLOYEE DISCIPLINE

A. **Right of Representation**

Upon request, a bargaining unit member shall be entitled to have present a representative of the Association during any meeting relative to disciplinary action.

B. **Probation, Suspension and Discharge**

New employees will be in a probationary period for six (6) months worked. After employees have satisfactorily completed their probationary period with the District, they shall not be suspended without pay or discharged without just cause.

C. **Principles of Progressive Discipline**

The District supports the principle of progressive and corrective discipline as a constructive means to address employee misconduct and encourage positive behavioral change. Before progressive discipline is applied, the administrator or supervisor shall have a conversation with the employee about the conduct in question, where appropriate.

Supervisors and administrators are encouraged to apply progressive discipline in situations where an employee appears willing and able to correct their behavior.

Progressive discipline is a structured approach to addressing misconduct, designed to promote improvement and deter future violations. Disciplinary action may be based on a variety of factors, including but not limited to:

1. The severity of the offense;
2. The frequency of the behavior or number of occurrences;
3. The employee's history of prior misconduct;
4. The time elapsed between incidents;
5. The employee's attitude and willingness to cooperate;
6. The employee's overall work performance and record; and
7. The totality of the circumstances.

While progressive discipline is encouraged and may be used when appropriate, the Board retains the right to determine the appropriate level of discipline based on the specific facts of each case. Accordingly, not all situations will warrant the use of progressive discipline, and some forms of misconduct may justify more immediate or severe disciplinary action.

D. Progressive Discipline Guidelines

The disciplinary process described below emphasizes taking progressive steps, where appropriate, to produce positive corrective action. While District 65 intends that in most cases progressive discipline will be administered, the specific form of discipline chosen in a particular case is solely within the discretion of District 65.

The goal of this process is that the employee is given guidance and information sufficient to prevent a recurrence of the action being addressed, while ensuring at each step that due process standards are being met. Discipline may result from violations of policy, law or directives, substandard performance (after attempts at improvement) and/or misconduct.

Misconduct

Misconduct by an employee will result in the imposition of discipline consistent with the seriousness of the misconduct. Conduct which falls into this category includes, but is not limited to:

- neglect of duty;
- insubordination
- use of illegal drugs, alcohol or any other chemical substance on the job or any use off the job which impacts on the employee's performance;
- deliberate and serious violation of the rights and freedoms of other employees, students, parents or other persons in the school community;
- failure to follow the canons of professional and personal ethics;
- falsification of credentials and experience;
- unauthorized destruction of School District property;
- violation of the rights of others as provided by federal and state laws related to human rights;
- providing false or misleading information to the School Board.
- other good and sufficient grounds relating to any other act constituting inappropriate conduct.

E. District 65 Progressive Discipline Steps

Step 0: Conversation – The administration or supervisor shall have a conversation with the employee about the conduct, where appropriate. Progressive discipline may not apply in all cases, as certain misconduct may warrant immediate or more serious action.

Step 1: Verbal Reprimand - The employee is informed that a violation or misconduct has occurred and must not be repeated. There needs to be a written record of a verbal reprimand that is shared with the employee.

Step 2: Written Reprimand - The employee is informed that the employee repeated the conduct warned of and that subsequent violations may result in suspension or termination or notice to remedy. This written reprimand will be placed in the employee's personnel file.

Step 3: Suspension without pay - This level of discipline a decision will be made in conjunction with Human Relations.

Step 4: Termination - This level of discipline will be made in conjunction with Human Relations.

F. Appeals Process

Should an employee consider disciplinary action to be improper, the employee may appeal the matter in accordance with the provisions of Article VII ("Grievance Procedure"), provided however, any such disciplinary grievance shall be filed within ten (10) school days after the employee receives notification of the discipline.

ARTICLE 5
EMPLOYEE EVALUATIONS

A. **Purpose**

The Association and the District recognize the need to have highly qualified and highly trained paraprofessionals who best serve the needs of the students. The primary purpose of evaluations shall be the improvement of employment skills contained in the job description and all evaluations shall be conducted in good faith to this end and in accordance with the provisions of this Agreement.

B. **Notification**

Upon initial employment, paraprofessionals shall be advised of the District's evaluation procedures by the Human Relations Department. No formal evaluation shall take place until this has been done.

Within fifteen (15) calendar days of the beginning of the school year, the building administrator or immediate supervisor shall conduct an evaluation orientation so as to fully inform each paraprofessional under their supervision with the evaluation procedures, evaluation tool and job description to be used, as well as, who will observe and evaluate their performance.

A new employee or a paraprofessional reassigned after the beginning of the school term shall be notified by the building administrator or immediate supervisor of the evaluation procedures in effect. Such notification shall be within fifteen (15) calendar days of the new assignment.

If modifications are made to the evaluation procedures and evaluation tool as agreed upon by the Joint Evaluation Committee, those shall be communicated to the paraprofessionals in a timeframe to be determined by the Joint Evaluation Committee.

C. **Evaluation Procedures**

The criteria and procedures in this Article shall be applied uniformly throughout the District for all paraprofessionals.

The District recognizes that the process of providing feedback is ongoing throughout the year and may be provided by the building administrator or immediate supervisor.

Concerns that may be raised in the evaluation should be discussed and provided to the

paraprofessional within five (5) school days of the concern so that the employee has the opportunity to remedy the concern and request additional support or development.

Paraprofessionals shall be formally evaluated every other year, unless there are deficiencies in performance on the formal evaluation, resulting as Needs Improvement or Unsatisfactory, in which case the paraprofessional shall be evaluated the following year. A formal evaluation shall include an observation by the building administrator or immediate supervisor, input from assigned classroom educators and/or assigned case manager, completion of the paraprofessional evaluation tool and a conference with the assigned evaluator.

Paraprofessionals shall have forty-eight (48) hour advance notification prior to the observation by the administrator. Each paraprofessional shall have a conference with their evaluator no later than ten (10) school days after the observation. A draft copy of the written evaluation tool shall be provided to the paraprofessional twenty-four (24) hours prior to the conference with their evaluator. The evaluation tool will be discussed at the evaluation conference with the evaluator. Within two (2) school days of the conference, a final copy of the written evaluation tool shall be provided to the paraprofessional.

Each employee shall have the opportunity to respond in writing to the formal evaluation. Each formal evaluation will become a part of the employee's personnel file.

D. Multiple Assigned Employees

All paraprofessionals who have multiple building/work locations or multiple assignments within a work location shall be assigned a primary evaluator.

E. Joint Evaluation Committee

The Joint Evaluation Committee shall meet at least once a school year. The purpose of the Joint Evaluation Committee is to review the evaluation tool related to the paraprofessional to ensure the tool reflects the responsibilities of the paraprofessionals, provides effective and meaningful feedback and to determine if any modifications are needed to the tool. The Joint Evaluation Committee shall be composed of an equal number of representatives from the Association and the District.

ARTICLE 6
PERSONNEL FILES

There shall be one official personnel file only. Employees shall have the right, upon reasonable notice, to review the post-employment contents of their own file. Employees shall have the right to a copy of any such item(s), provided they shall reimburse the District for the cost of such reproduction. Employees shall have the right to respond to any critical or derogatory material contained in their personnel file and to have such response placed in their personnel file.

Employees shall be notified within ten (10) work days (when the Joseph E. Hill Administration Center is open) of any disciplinary matters placed in their personnel files.

ARTICLE 7
GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

A. **Definitions**

1. Any claim by the Association or any employee that there has been a violation, misinterpretation or misapplication of the terms of this Agreement, shall be a grievance.

2. The failure of an employee or the Association to act on any grievance within the prescribed time limits will act as a bar to any further appeal. An administrator's failure to give a decision within the prescribed time limits shall permit the grievance automatically to proceed to the next step. These time limits may be extended by mutual written agreement.

3. All the time limits consist of days when the District's Joseph E. Hill Administration Center is open.

B. **Procedures**

The parties hereby acknowledge that it is usually most desirable for an employee and the employee's immediately involved supervisor to resolve problems through free and informal communications. When requested by the employee, an Association representative may accompany the employee to assist in the informal resolution of the grievance. If, however, the informal process fails to satisfy the employee or the Association, a grievance may be processed as follows:

1. STEP I - Within twenty (20) days following the occurrence of the event giving rise to the grievance, the employee or the Association may present the grievance in writing to the immediate supervisor, who will arrange for a meeting to take place within ten (10) days after receipt of the grievance. The Association's representative, the grievant, and the immediate supervisor shall be present for the meeting. Within ten (10) days of the meeting, the grievance and the Association shall be provided with the Head of Human Relations' written response, including the reasons for the decisions.

2. STEP II - If the grievance is not resolved at Step I, then the Association may refer the grievance to the Superintendent of the Superintendent's official designee within ten (10) days after the Step I answer. The Superintendent or designee shall arrange with the Association representatives for a meeting to take place within then (10) days of the Superintendent's receipt of the appeal. Each party shall have the right to include in its representation such witnesses and internal representatives as it deems necessary. Within

ten (10) days of the meeting, the Association shall be provided with the Superintendent's or designee's written response, including the reasons for the decision.

3. STEP III - If the Association is not satisfied with the disposition of the grievance at Step II, the Association may submit the grievance to arbitration through the American Arbitration Association ("AAA"), which shall act as the administrator of the proceedings. If a demand for arbitration is not filed within twenty (20) days of the date for the Step II answer, then the grievance shall be deemed withdrawn. The arbitrator shall follow the standard rules of the AAA, and shall have no authority or jurisdiction to add to, subtract from, alter, or modify the terms of this Agreement. Arbitration awards in keeping with the preceding sentence shall be final and binding upon the parties. The arbitrator's fees and expenses shall be borne equally by the parties. If the parties agree, the arbitrator may follow AAA's expedited rules.

C. Bypass to Step II

If the Association and the immediate supervisor agree, Step I of the grievance procedure may be bypassed and the grievance brought directly to Step II.

D. Bypass to Arbitration

If the Superintendent or their designee and the Association agree, a grievance may be submitted directly to arbitration.

E. Association Participation - Employee Representation

The Board acknowledges the right of the Association's grievance representative to participate in the processing of a grievance at any level, and no employee shall be required to discuss any grievance if the Association's representative is not present.

F. Released Time

Should the investigation or processing of any grievance require that employees be released from their regular assignment, such employee shall be released without loss of pay or benefits.

G. Grievance Withdrawal

A grievance may be withdrawn at any level without establishing precedent.

H. Grievance Documents

Grievances and documents pertaining solely to the processing of grievances shall be kept separate from employee personnel files.

ARTICLE 8

LEAVES

A. Sick Leave

At the beginning of each school year, each full-time employee shall be credited with ten (10) days of sick leave equal to the number of hours they regularly work each day - the unused portion of which shall accumulate from year to year without limitation. Sick leave days will be prorated for paraprofessionals who are hired during the school year.

Sick leave shall be interpreted to mean personal illness, mental or behavioral health complications, quarantine at home, serious illness or death in the immediate family or household, or birth, adoption, placement for adoption, and the acceptance of a child in need of foster care. For purposes of this section the immediate family or household includes parents, spouse, civil union spouse, domestic partner, siblings, children, grandparents, grandchildren, in-laws and legal guardians. Sick leave taken because of serious illness in the immediate family or household shall not exceed one (1) calendar month in any school year. Special expectations may be made by approval of the Board.

B. Funeral Leave

Employees shall be granted up to three (3) days of funeral leave which may be used in connection with the death of a member of the employee's immediate family or household as defined in Paragraph A above, or the employee's domestic partner's immediate family. This is apart from sick leave and is non-cumulative.

C. Workers' Compensation

Absence due to injury or illness incurred in the course of employment and which qualifies for workers' compensation under the Illinois Workers' Compensation Act, shall not be charged against the employee's sick leave days, provided that the employee shall pay to the District the salary insurance received under the Illinois Workers' Compensation Act for the duration of such absence.

D. Personal Business Leave

At the beginning of each school year, each employee shall be credited with two (2) days to be used for personal business. An employee planning to use a personal business leave day or days shall notify their supervisor at least two (2) days in advance, except in cases of emergency. Personal business leave days shall be available for the practice of individual religious preferences regardless of the day of the week. Such leave shall be

non-cumulative as personal business days, but will be added to the accumulated sick leave days available to the employee. The day immediately preceding or immediately following a legal holiday or school recess shall not be recognized as a personal leave day except upon approval of the Head of Human Relations. Requests for such exceptions must be submitted in writing to the Head of Human Relations as soon as possible.

Paraprofessionals who seek to use a second personal business day in a semester, or who have attendance issues, may be asked for the reason for the need to take a personal business day. The decision to grant/deny a personal business day will not be made on an arbitrary or capricious basis.

E. Jury Duty

Any employee called for jury duty during working hours shall be paid their full salary for such time and suffer no loss of benefits or contractual advantage.

F. Statement of Available Leave

The District shall furnish each employee with a written statement semi-annually during the work year setting forth the total unused leave day credit available under the Article.

G. Unpaid Maternity/Parental Leave

1. Unpaid Maternity Leave

- a. If a maternity leave in connection with child birth is desired, the employee shall arrange for a meeting with the Head of Human Relations or their designee. The purpose of the conference shall be to determine a mutually agreeable plan for the leave.
- b. Employees shall notify the Head of Human Relations in writing if they desire to return after the leave is completed. This written notification shall be accompanied by a physician's written statement that the returning employee is physically able to resume full duties. Employees who wish to return from maternity leave as soon as they are physically able, shall be allowed to do so. Otherwise, employees shall return within six (6) months, except that ten-month employees may postpone their return until the commencement of the next school year even if doing so results in a leave of greater than six (6) months. Any employee returning from maternity leave shall be returned to a position comparable ("equal pay") to that which they held prior to the maternity leave, provided that nothing contained

herein shall be interpreted to insulate employees on maternity leave from reductions in force.

- c. Employees whose maternity leave exceeds six (6) months shall submit the written notice of intention to return referred to in subparagraph b. above no later than March 1st. Failure to comply with the notice to return requirements for maternity leave shall be treated as an election not to return to employment and shall be considered a voluntary resignation from the District.
- d. Any insurance benefits under the provisions of this Agreement which would otherwise accrue to an employee shall be suspended on the first day of the month immediately following the beginning of the leave of absence. Except as provided in Paragraph I (FMLA), any employee on maternity leave may make arrangements during said leave to continue insurance coverage as provided in this Agreement at her own expense. Any employee granted maternity leave who has completed ninety (90) days or more of the school year prior to said leave shall be considered to have completed a full year for purposes of any applicable advancement on the salary schedule.
- e. Any employee desiring maternity leave as a result of becoming an adoptive parent shall notify the Head of Human Relations, in writing, upon the initiation of such adoption proceedings. Leave shall be granted upon satisfactory written notification to the Head of Human Relations of the date the child is expected to be received. It shall be the responsibility of the applying employee to keep the Head of Human Relations informed on the status of the proceedings, and, as soon as known, the expected date of the delivery of the child.

2. Unpaid Parental Leave

Unpaid parental leave shall be granted to an employee, upon request, to begin any time between the birth or adoption of their child and three (3) calendar months thereafter. Subparagraphs a. through e. above shall apply to parental leaves, except for the disability language of subparagraph b. and the first sentence of subparagraph c.

H. Unpaid Leave of Absence

A leave may be requested in writing for a period not to exceed one (1) year from the date of leaving. Whether or not to grant an unpaid leave of absence shall be at the complete discretion of the Board of Education. An employee shall notify the Head of Human Relations in writing two (2) months prior to the expiration date of the leave if they desires to return after the leave period is completed. The employee shall be returned to a comparable job as soon as is practicable, but not necessarily the same position held prior to the leave of absence. Notwithstanding the foregoing, employees on unpaid leave of absence shall not be insulated from reductions in force.

I. The Family and Medical Leave Act ("FMLA")

The District shall coordinate the benefits provided under this Agreement with those provided under the FMLA. To the extent required by the FMLA, the District will continue to provide hospitalization insurance to eligible employees on Family and Medical Leave for up to twelve (12) weeks in a rolling twelve (12) month period, on the same basis and contribution level as if they were on the active payroll. An eligible employee is one who has worked for the District for at least twelve (12) months and has worked at least 1,250 hours during the twelve (12) months prior to the start of the FMLA leave. All hours worked for the District shall be counted toward the 1,250 hours necessary to be eligible for FMLA leave. Any concerns related to the application of this section may be brought to the attention of the Head of Human Relations but may not be the subject of a grievance under this Agreement.

J. Exemption from Cook County Paid Leave Ordinance

In accordance with Section 42-5 of the Cook County Paid Leave Ordinance, the employees included in the bargaining unit recognition clause within the Preamble to this Agreement hereby waive the paid leave provided by the Ordinance, as set forth in Section 42-3(c)1-14 of the Ordinance. The parties agree that the Association is waiving the ordinance as currently enacted and in no way is waiving any updates to the ordinance during the duration of this Agreement.

ARTICLE 9
MANAGEMENT RIGHTS

The Board retains the right to manage the District and its paraprofessionals and direct the work of the paraprofessionals in the manner it determines to be in the best interests of the District. Such right includes, but is not limited to, the right to: hire, discipline and discharge employees; relieve employees from duty because of lack of work or other legitimate reasons; determine the duties, responsibilities and qualifications of employees, and the manner in which the work is to be performed; determine the size of the work force; and establish and enforce rules and regulations applicable to employees, so long as such rules and regulations do not conflict with the express terms and conditions of this Agreement.

ARTICLE 10
NO STRIKE OR WORK STOPPAGE

During the term of this Agreement there shall be no strike, work stoppage, picketing, or any other form of concerted activity by the paraprofessionals, the purpose of which is to cause District employees to render less than full and complete services to the District, by the Union, its members, or any employees covered by this Agreement. This prohibition applies to strikes and work stoppages for any reason, whether grievable or not.

ARTICLE 11
WORKING CONDITIONS

A. **Work Day**

The normal work day for full-time paraprofessionals shall be:

- Early Childhood, Elementary Schools, Park, and Rice Assignments: six (6) hours per day exclusive of the paraprofessionals' unpaid thirty (30 minute) lunch period and any bus duty.
- Magnet School Assignments: six (6) hours and fifteen (15) minutes per day exclusive of the paraprofessionals' unpaid thirty (30) minute lunch period and any bus duty.
- Middle School Assignments: six (6) hours and thirty (30) minutes per day exclusive of the paraprofessionals' unpaid thirty-five (35) minute lunch period and any bus duty.

All required hours of work as a paraprofessional (not counting, for example, lunch or bus duty) will be paid at the normal hourly rate-unless the paraprofessional is assigned to work more than forty (40) hours in any one week, in which case the paraprofessional will be compensated at one and one-half (1½) times their hourly rate. Holidays and approved sick leave shall be included when calculating the forty (40) hours. Every reasonable effort will be made insofar as practicable while maintaining appropriate supervision for children, to provide each paraprofessional with one fifteen (15) minute break each day. Such break shall be scheduled in consultation with the coordinating educator or appropriate administrator.

B. **Duties**

1. The building administrator or the immediate supervisor shall communicate to paraprofessionals regarding their responsibilities related to servicing students. Within seven (7) school days after the first day of student attendance, paraprofessionals will receive a copy of their schedule in writing, which shall include their daily responsibilities and lunch break. If this schedule is modified, paraprofessionals will be notified as soon as practicable.
2. Paraprofessionals shall be invited to attend special education team meetings where specific students are being discussed. The paraprofessional's attendance at such meeting shall be voluntary.

3. Paraprofessionals shall have the option to complete a total of three (3) additional hours outside of their work day during each of the two (2) Parent-Teacher Conference Weeks in order to have the Friday of that week as a non-attendance day. If a paraprofessional is unable to complete an additional of three (3) hours outside of their work day, they must complete three (3) hours on the Friday of the Parent-Teacher Conference Week.

C. Substitutes

When a paraprofessional is absent, the District shall make every reasonable effort to employ a substitute.

D. Work Year

The official work year calendar will be established yearly and will become an appendix to this Agreement. When adopted, the calendar shall include 205 days (1,230 hours): 176 work days, 10 paid holidays, 15 paid vacation days and 4 institute days which are considered regular work days.

E. Optional Summer Employment

District paraprofessionals shall be considered for available summer positions for Extended School Year or Board approved Summer School Programs. The summer school salary shall be one thousand six hundred fifty dollars (\$1650). An additional two hundred dollar (\$200) stipend will be paid to those paraprofessionals who participate in a one (1) day summer learning in-service.

An additional stipend shall be provided to paraprofessionals who participate in Extended School Year or Board approved Summer School Programs with the following length of service in the District:

5 years or less	\$500
6 -10 years	\$750
11+ years	\$1000

Paraprofessionals who work at Park School shall receive an additional stipend of one thousand five hundred dollars (\$1500) after working two (2) consecutive years in place of the above stipend.

Participating paraprofessionals will receive their summer school salary in a separate check, provided that such is administratively feasible. Payment will be made no later than the second pay day following the last day of the program.

Any additional stipends shall be paid in the paraprofessionals' first summer school check.

F. Bus Duty

1. When assigning bus duty, preference shall be given to ETAA bargaining unit members who are assigned at the building from which the route departs.
2. The Administration will develop and communicate a plan to provide appropriate student supervision in the event that a bus arrives early or is late. Specific building concerns should be brought to the attention of the building administrator. In the event that a bus aide exceeds one (1) hour of time inclusion of the bus route and supervision of students before or after school, that additional time shall be noted on the bus aide's time sheet and paid as an additional route.
3. Paraprofessionals who are assigned bus duty will receive sixteen (\$16) dollars per bus route.
4. Paraprofessionals who are assigned bus duty shall be provided with a cell phone for such duty.

G. Seniority

Length of service with the District is one of the factors which the District will consider when assigning paraprofessionals to positions at the commencement of the school year and when recalling paraprofessionals who are on layoff.

H. Safety for Paraprofessionals

Paraprofessionals shall not be required to work under unsafe or hazardous conditions or to perform tasks which endanger their health, safety or wellbeing. The Administration shall promptly review and respond to any safety concerns about the work environment which are communicated by the Association to the Administration.

Paraprofessionals will be provided direction related to resources and tools/equipment (i.e: Behavior Intervention Plans and/or safety plans) to proactively support individual students who may demonstrate dysregulation, physical aggression and/or may cause severe physical harm. Professional Development shall be offered for paraprofessionals that includes crisis de-escalation, restorative practices, identifying signs of distress, trauma informed practices, and behavior management. See Article XI, Section N for Professional Development and Training.

The Board, Administration and Association agree that any threat of aggression, physical aggression and/or severe physical harm against an employee is a matter of serious concern.

If a paraprofessional is threatened with physical aggression, experiences physical aggression and/or experiences severe physical harm by a student, the Administrator shall collaborate with the affected paraprofessional to provide support(s) according to Board Policy to address concerns prior to the student's return to the classroom or the student's regular schedule. Every reasonable effort will be made for this collaboration to occur within twenty-four (24) hours of the incident.

When such an incident occurs during the paraprofessional's workday or at a District sanctioned event:

- The paraprofessional shall promptly report the incident to the building administrator and then shall complete an Incident Report provided by the building administrator or their designee and submit it to the Superintendent or designee.
- If injured, the paraprofessional shall also file an Employee's Report of Injury provided by the building administrator or their designee with the Superintendent or designee.

Absences resulting from such incidents shall not be deducted from the paraprofessional's accumulated sick or personal leave, provided the required reports are filed. The Superintendent or designee may request supporting medical documentation. The Human Relations Department shall provide information about Workers Compensation Benefits to the affected paraprofessional.

A paraprofessional shall be reimbursed for personal property damaged in the course of assigned duties, provided that reasonable care was taken and the appropriate form to submit for liability insurance has been filed. The Administration may request reasonable supporting documentation.

I. Breakfast and Lunchroom/Recess Supervision Duty

Each paraprofessional who voluntarily accepts breakfast and/or lunchroom/recess supervision duty during otherwise duty-free time will be paid twenty dollars (\$20) per duty.

J. Good Attendance Bonus

If an employee is absent no more than one (1) day per semester, the employee will receive a gross \$175 bonus per semester. If the employee is absent no more than one (1) day each semester in a school year, the employee will receive an additional gross \$100 bonus for a total of \$450 for the school year. (Approved Funeral Leave and Jury Duty do not count as absences under this paragraph).

K. Mutual Respect

Paraprofessionals, Administrators and Board Members recognize the importance of treating each other with professionalism, dignity and respect.

L. Secured Space

Every paraprofessional will have a secure space to keep their belongings.

M. Professional Development Learning and Mandatory Training

1. The Board, District and Association recognize the need and importance to provide training, ongoing support and opportunities for professional growth and development for paraprofessionals.

2. Professional Development is defined as any District-initiated staff training, instructional workshops, in-service, or professional learning opportunity provided to paraprofessionals for the purpose of building knowledge, enhancing job-related skills, and supporting professional growth. This does not include mandatory training such as GCN (Global Compliance Network) modules or other state/federally mandated training that are required for all staff.

3. The building administrator or their immediate supervisor shall provide paraprofessionals with IEPs At-A-Glance and/or health, behavior and safety plans to ensure they have knowledge of students' specific needs, interventions, modifications and/or accommodations by the end of the second Institute Day or prior to a student's first day of attendance.

4. The building administrator or the immediate supervisor shall assign each newly-hired paraprofessional a mentor within the first two (2) weeks of employment. The Association President shall be provided a list of newly-hired paraprofessionals and their assigned mentors monthly.

5. Professional development on early release on early release days shall be held during the employee's regular work hours. On full-day institute and/or school improvement days (when students are not in attendance) the start and end time will be

8:30-3:00. On full-day institute or full-day school improvement days, paraprofessionals shall have no less than 60 (sixty) minutes for lunch which includes travel time.

Each school year, four (4) early release days will be allocated and structured in a manner that allows paraprofessionals the opportunity to collaborate, which includes, but is not limited to, sharing ideas/strategies, problem solving, and building community, while also including training determined by the Joint Professional Development Committee. The District will provide notice to the Association, as well as an opportunity to bargain the impact, if the current early release model changes.

6. The Joint Professional Development Committee shall be composed of an equal number of District and Association representatives, that shall meet at least three (3) times annually. By the second Friday in March, the Joint Professional Development Committee will survey paraprofessionals to assess professional development needs. Based on the survey results, the Committee will identify a list of relevant topics for professional development. The District shall share and implement the finalized list of mandatory training and professional development with all paraprofessionals by the end of the second Institute Day the next school year. Dedicated time will be provided for paraprofessionals to collaborate, share ideas, and exchange effective strategies that support their success in the role.

7. Employees may contact their immediate supervisor or principal to request professional development as the need arises. All requests must align with the employee's role within the District and be approved by Human Relations. Once approved, the District will cover the cost of the professional development. If a request is denied, the paraprofessional can appeal their request to the Superintendent or their designee.

8. When assigning employees who will be responsible for physically lifting a child as part of their duties, the District will provide training and/or instruction to prevent injury. When multiple employees are needed to lift a child, a plan will be developed.

ARTICLE 12
REDUCTION IN FORCE

A. Definition

A reduction in force (RIF) shall be defined as any action by the Board that results in the reduction of hours, decrease in the number of paraprofessionals employed or the discontinuance of some particular type of educational support service resulting in the removal or honorable dismissal of paraprofessionals as defined by Illinois School Code Section 105 ILCS 5/10-23.5.

B. Reduction In Force Procedures and Notice

Prior to implementation of any reduction in force, the District shall notify the Association President of such reduction in force no later than fourteen (14) school days prior to its presentation to the Board. The Association will be afforded a reasonable opportunity to review and respond in writing to the District's proposed reduction in force plan prior to the Board's implementation of a reduction in force.

The District shall follow the procedures set forth in 105 ILCS Section 5/10-23.5 of the School Code once the Board has approved implementation of a reduction in force.

Written notice shall be mailed by the District to the employee and also given to the employee either by certified mail, return receipt requested, or personal delivery with receipt, at least thirty (30) days before the employee is removed or dismissed or the hours they work are reduced, together with a statement of honorable dismissal and the reason therefor if applicable. If a reduction in hours is due to an unforeseen reduction in the student population, then the written notice must be mailed and given to the employee at least five (5) days before the hours are reduced.

C. Seniority

The District, in consultation with the Association shall annually establish a list, categorized by positions, showing the length of continuing service for each full time paraprofessional and the positions for which they are qualified to hold. Copies of the list shall be distributed to the Association President on or before February 1st of each year. Paraprofessionals with the shorter length of continuing service with the District shall be dismissed first. Ties in seniority shall be resolved by the date and time of hire, as approved by the Board based on Board Minutes.

D. Recall Rights

Following a RIF, paraprofessionals will have recall rights under this Article for up to one (1) year, except that if the layoff occurs at the conclusion of a school year the paraprofessional(s) shall retain recall rights until the commencement of the second ensuing school year. Paraprofessionals shall retain any seniority accrued prior to the RIF as set forth in 105 ILCS 5/10-23.5 .

If during the time period when a paraprofessional is eligible for recall, a position opens up with the same educator and class from which the paraprofessional was laid off, that paraprofessional will have recall rights to that job. In addition, if any other vacancy in the bargaining unit occurs during this time period, laid-off employees shall be hired prior to non-district or non-bargaining unit applicants, provided the paraprofessional is immediately available, qualified and able to perform the responsibilities required for the vacant positions.

E. Payment of All Earned Compensation

In a RIF, the paraprofessional shall receive all earned compensation on or before the next regular pay date following their last day of employment as set forth in 105 ILCS 5/10-23.5.

ARTICLE 13
ASSIGNMENTS, VACANCIES, AND TRANSFERS

A. Notification of Assignments

Paraprofessionals shall be notified in writing of their tentative building and classroom assignments at least fifteen (15) calendar days prior to the first staff Institute Day. If there are concerns regarding assignment changes, paraprofessionals may request a meeting with an appropriate administrator.

B. Definition of Vacancy

A vacancy is defined as a newly-created position or a current position within the bargaining unit that the Board desires to fill.

C. Posting for Vacancies

When a vacancy occurs in any bargaining unit position, notice of such position shall be posted on the District website within ten (10) school days of the vacancy and a copy of such bargaining unit positions shall be sent to the Association President.

Any revisions to ETAA bargaining unit job descriptions will be shared with the Association President.

D. Application for Transfer

The District shall post vacancies on the District 65 website (www.district65.net) as they become available.

Transfer Process:

1. Notice of interest to an existing vacancy should be sent in writing to the current building administrator and the Human Relations Department.
2. A paraprofessional will submit an electronic transfer request form from the District 65 website identifying the existing vacancy they are interested in applying for.
3. The Head of the Human Relations and the relevant building administrator(s) shall review all requests.
4. An interview will be scheduled if applying for a vacancy in a different building.
5. The final decision shall be communicated in writing within ten (10) school days of making the decision.

E. In-District Preference/Seniority

The District shall consider all bargaining unit employees when applying for job openings within the bargaining unit. Among the factors the District shall consider are qualifications, length of service with the District, and performance.

F. Involuntary Transfers

Should an involuntary transfer from one building to another of a bargaining unit employee be necessary, the paraprofessional shall be notified as soon as practicable possible and shall promptly have an opportunity to meet with the Head of Human Relations or other appropriate administrator regarding same. Every reasonable effort shall be made to provide a minimum of ten (10) school days when a paraprofessional is being involuntarily transferred.

ARTICLE 14

COMPENSATION AND FRINGE BENEFITS

All paraprofessional salaries shall be retroactive from the 1st day of attendance in the 25-26 school year.

A. Salary Schedule

The salary schedule for paraprofessionals is set forth in Appendix A attached hereto.

Each paraprofessional will receive the following increases:

FY26 a base increase of 6.5%, plus step

FY27 a base increase of 2%, plus step

FY28 a base increase of 2%, plus step

FY29 a base increase of 2%, plus step

Further, each paraprofessional who does not advance a step in a school year because they are at the top of the salary schedule will receive a, one-time lump sum bonus based on the following:

5.5% for 2-7 years on top step;

6.5% for 8-15 years on top step;

and 8.0% for 16 or more years on top step in December of each year of the

Agreement, provided they are employed by the District as a paraprofessional when the bonus is payable.

To the extent that the receipt of the stipend will result in a paraprofessional receiving more than six percent (6%) increase in total salary over the previous year's salary, the remaining portion shall be paid to the paraprofessional in the second calendar month after the effective date of the employee's retirement.

B. Pay Periods

1. Paraprofessionals will be paid on the 15th and 30th of each month in which they are working. At the employee's option, the District either shall distribute paychecks to each employee at their workplace, or directly deposit the employee's paycheck.

2. Paraprofessionals who so elect may have their pay spread out over twelve (12) months.

C. Vacation

Paraprofessionals will receive fifteen (15) days of vacation in each full school year. The fifteen (15) days shall include the days of fall, winter and spring break during which the schools are closed.

D. Holidays

Paraprofessionals who are working will receive ten (10) paid holidays.

E. Retirement Stipend

The District will pay employees who retire with at least fifteen (15) years of in-District service a one-time, gross, lump sum payment based on the table below.

<u>Years of Service</u>	<u>Lump Sum Payment</u>
15	\$1,150
16	\$1,225
17	\$1,300
18	\$1,375
19	\$1,450
20	\$1,525
21	\$1,600
22	\$1,675
23	\$1,750
24	\$1,825
25	\$1,900
26	\$1,975
27	\$2,050
28	\$2,125
29	\$2,200
30	\$2,275
31	\$2,350
32	\$2,425
33	\$2,500
34	\$2,575
35	\$2,650

36	\$2,725
37	\$2,800
38	\$2,875
39	\$2,950
40	\$3,025
41	\$3,100
42	\$3,175
43	\$3,250
44	\$3,325
45	\$3,400

To the extent that receipt of the stipend will result in an employee receiving more than a six percent (6%) increase in total salary over the previous year's salary, the remaining portion shall be paid to the employee in the second calendar month after the effective date of the employee's retirement.

F. Payment for Unused Sick Leave

Upon retirement or honorable dismissal of a bargaining unit employee, the Board of Education will pay thirty-five dollars (\$35) per day for up to one hundred eighty (180) days of accumulated sick leave, excluding days which the employee chooses to credit for IMRF purposes. To the extent that the receipt of the stipend will result in an employee receiving more than a six percent (6%) increase in total salary over the previous year's salary, the remaining portion shall be paid to the employee the second calendar month after the effective date of the employee's retirement.

G. Professional Growth

Five hundred dollars (\$500) shall be made available to each paraprofessional annually for the purpose of professional growth and the retirement of skills (i.e., course in child development, specific management techniques, first aid, in-service training workshops, etc.). This money shall be awarded after approval by the Head of Human Relations on the appropriateness of the request. A full in-service day will be established yearly and will be part of the official calendar. Staff will have an opportunity to propose content for in-service, and attendance will be mandatory. Certificates of Attendance will be provided to employees who attend the entire in-service.

H. Substitute Teaching

Upon prior approval of the Head of Human Relations or their designee, paraprofessionals who are qualified to serve as substitute teachers as determined by the Illinois State Board of Education shall receive, in addition to their daily rate, forty dollars (\$40.00) for any service as a substitute teacher for up to one-half (1/2) of the school day, and eighty dollars (\$80.00) for any service as a substitute teacher beyond one-half (1/2) of the school day. These additional earnings shall be reported to TRS as creditable earnings.

If a paraprofessional is serving as a substitute teacher for more than forty (40) days consecutively, that paraprofessional shall be paid at the daily substitute rate of \$150.00 in addition to their daily rate.

I. Insurance

1. Coverage

All full-time paraprofessionals will be eligible for coverage under the District's health insurance plan. The District will not change its health insurance plan without first providing notice to the Association as well as an opportunity for Association input. The Board agrees to reduce the health insurance in all PPO plans by one percent (1%) for the 2025-2026, 2026-2027, and 2027-2028 school years.

Employees who elect coverage under one of the District's health insurance plans shall pay the applicable percentage of the insurance cost set forth below:

Medical

2025-2026	HMOI	HMO Blue Advantage	PPO
Single	9%	9%	38%
Employee +1	25%	16%	38%
Family	25%	16%	32%

2026-2027	HMOI	HMO Blue Advantage	PPO
Single	9%	9%	37%
Employee +1	25%	16%	37%
Family	25%	16%	31%

2027-2028	HMOI	HMO Blue Advantage	PPO
Single	9%	9%	36%
Employee +1	25%	16%	36%
Family	25%	16%	30%

2028-2029	HMOI	HMO Blue Advantage	PPO
Single	9%	9%	36%
Employee +1	25%	16%	36%
Family	25%	16%	30%

Dental

	HMO Dental	PPO Dental
Employee	19%	19%
Employee +1	50%	60%
Family	50%	60%

Insurance coverage shall be based on a plan year of September 1 through August 31. The District will offer an expanded §125 plan for employee pre-tax contributions for insurance premiums, out-of-pocket medical expenses, and dependent care expenses consistent with the Internal Revenue Code and IRS Regulations. The District will pay all of the administrative costs. Terms of the §125 plan will control.

An employee shall be allowed to enroll their civil union spouse or domestic partner for medical and dental coverage on the same basis that employees may enroll their spouse, provided that their civil union spouse or domestic partner is eligible pursuant to the District's eligibility criteria in effect as of the effective date of this Agreement and the applicable Affidavit of Domestic Partnership is completed and executed.

2. Joint Insurance Committee

A Joint Insurance Committee will be established for the purpose of reviewing avenues and options to contain or decrease the cost of current and future health insurance.

The Committee will be comprised of, but not limited to, the Head of Human Relations, the Chief Financial Officer, one (1) member of the DEC Council, the DEC President, and one member of each ESP bargaining unit appointed by each unit's President. As Chair, the District's Head of Human Relations shall be responsible for scheduling meetings and preparing the written information for each meeting. The Committee will meet as necessary but at least three (3) times per year.

The work of the Committee shall be collaborative in order to promote a wide range of views and opinions as insurance options are reviewed. It shall have access to necessary information in order to do this. The Committee chair will provide these materials to the Committee members. However, the Chair will protect the confidentiality of individual plan participants as required by the ADA or other applicable law. Further the Committee may meet with the District broker and an IEA approved consultant who may provide recommendations concerning the plan design and options, interpret data generated from reports of carriers, and provide projections of future plan experience. It shall be the responsibility of the District's broker to contact all potential providers.

Recommendations of the Insurance Committee will be forwarded to the Board of Education. The Board shall review and consider the recommendations as it determines plan options for District employees.

The Board and Council are free to use information, reports and recommendations generated by the Committee in formulating proposals for use in collective bargaining.

J. Long-Term Disability Insurance

The Board of Education will provide a long-term disability insurance policy to cover all full-time employees. This plan provides for 60% of salary (up to \$3,500 per month) if the employee is disabled from sickness or an accident and is effective on the ninety-first (91st) day of disability. This benefit is payable until the disability ends or until age 65, whichever occurs first.

K. Term Life Insurance

The Board of Education will provide a term life insurance policy in the amount of forty-five thousand dollars (\$45,000) for all full-time, ten (10) month paraprofessionals up to age seventy (70), at which age the benefit is reduced in accordance with the carrier's reduction schedule.

L. Physical Exam Reimbursement

The Board of Education will reimburse up to one hundred fifty dollars (\$150) every other year toward the cost of an annual physical exam for each full-time paraprofessional.

M. Longevity Stipend

Each paraprofessional who completes twenty (20) years of continuous service as a paraprofessional in the District will receive a one-time, gross six hundred dollar (\$600) lump sum payment at the conclusion of the twentieth (20th) consecutive year in the District.

N. IMRF Early Retirement Legislation

If during the life of this Agreement legislation is enacted that provides for an enhanced early retirement opportunity for employees under the Illinois Municipal Retirement Fund, either Board or the Association may reopen this Agreement on the sole issue of implementing such legislation by serving written notice on the other party within fifteen (15) calendar days of enactment of such legislation. If such a reopener occurs, the Board is willing to engage in the reopener negotiations with each non-certified group jointly.

O. Employee Assistance Plan

The District will offer an Employee Assistance Plan (EAP) to employees.

P. Section 457 Plan

The Board will offer an approved Section 457 plan to all employees.

ARTICLE 15
NEGOTIATIONS PROCEDURES

- A. The parties agree to fulfill whatever obligations that they may have under the Illinois Educational Labor Relations Act regarding the negotiation of a successor agreement.
- B. Each party in negotiations shall select its respective representatives, provided that neither party's team shall consist of more than six (6) members. Within thirty (30) days following the first bargaining meeting, complete proposals as to all non-economic matters shall be made by both parties.

ARTICLE 16
SCOPE AND EFFECT OF AGREEMENT

- A. This Agreement constitutes the entire and complete commitment and agreement between the parties concerning wages and terms and conditions of employment for the duration of the Agreement. The parties hereby agree that this Agreement is in full settlement of all outstanding issues between the parties, and that this Agreement may be altered, changed, added to, deleted from, or modified only through the mutual consent of the parties in a written, executed amendment to this Agreement.
- B. If any provision of this Agreement is declared by the proper judicial or legislative authority to be unlawful, unenforceable or unconstitutional, all other provisions of this Agreement shall remain in full force and effect for the duration thereof.
- C. Notwithstanding any other provisions contained herein, Articles V, VIII, XI, Sections A through C and F, XII, and XIII herein will not automatically apply to summer sessions.
- D. This Agreement shall continue in effect until the commencement of the 2029-2030 school year, unless it is extended for a specific period by the written agreement of the parties hereto.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the Agreement is executed this **January 26, 2026**

For the Board of Education of Evanston
School District No. 65,

Patricia S. Anderson

Its President

For the Evanston Teacher Assistants
Association,

Cynthia Battb

Its President

APPENDIX A-1

ETAA PARAPROFESSIONAL SALARY SCHEDULES

ETAA Salary Schedule (SY2025-2026)

Paraprofessional

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2025-2026			2025-2026			2025-2026		
6.5% Increase plus step			6.5% Increase plus step			6.5% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	23.36	\$28,732.80	1	23.36	\$29,930.00	1	23.36	\$31,127.20
2	24.05	\$29,581.50	2	24.05	\$30,814.06	2	24.05	\$32,046.63
3	24.75	\$30,442.50	3	24.75	\$31,710.94	3	24.75	\$32,979.38
4	25.77	\$31,697.10	4	25.77	\$33,017.81	4	25.77	\$34,338.53
5	26.84	\$33,013.20	5	26.84	\$34,388.75	5	26.84	\$35,764.30
6	27.86	\$34,267.80	6	27.86	\$35,695.63	6	27.86	\$37,123.45
7	28.88	\$35,522.40	7	28.88	\$37,002.50	7	28.88	\$38,482.60
8	29.98	\$36,875.40	8	29.98	\$38,411.88	8	29.98	\$39,948.35
9	31.14	\$38,302.20	9	31.14	\$39,898.13	9	31.14	\$41,494.05
10	32.38	\$39,827.40	10	32.38	\$41,486.88	10	32.38	\$43,146.35
11	33.06	\$40,663.80	11	33.06	\$42,358.13	11	33.06	\$44,052.45
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,236.51	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,329.70	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,422.88
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,643.15	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,753.28	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,863.41
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,253.10	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,388.65	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,524.20

Paraprofessional - Signing Aide

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2025-2026			2025-2026			2025-2026		
6.5% Increase plus step			6.5% Increase plus step			6.5% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	31.35	\$38,560.50	1	31.35	\$40,167.19	1	31.35	\$41,773.88
2	32.29	\$39,716.70	2	32.29	\$41,371.56	2	32.29	\$43,026.43
3	33.26	\$40,909.80	3	33.26	\$42,614.38	3	33.26	\$44,318.95
4	34.26	\$42,139.80	4	34.26	\$43,895.63	4	34.26	\$45,651.45
5	35.28	\$43,394.40	5	35.28	\$45,202.50	5	35.28	\$47,010.60
6	36.34	\$44,698.20	6	36.34	\$46,560.63	6	36.34	\$48,423.05
7	37.45	\$46,063.50	7	37.45	\$47,982.81	7	37.45	\$49,902.13
8	38.56	\$47,428.80	8	38.56	\$49,405.00	8	38.56	\$51,381.20
9	39.72	\$48,855.60	9	39.72	\$50,891.25	9	39.72	\$52,926.90
10	40.92	\$50,331.60	10	40.92	\$52,428.75	10	40.92	\$54,525.90
11	42.14	\$51,832.20	11	42.14	\$53,991.88	11	42.14	\$56,151.55
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,850.77	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,969.55	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,088.34
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,369.09	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,509.47	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,649.85
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,146.58	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,319.35	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,492.12

ETAA Salary Schedule (SY2026-2027)

Paraprofessional

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2026-2027			2026-2027			2026-2027		
2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	23.83	\$29,310.90	1	23.83	\$30,532.19	1	23.83	\$31,753.48
2	24.53	\$30,171.90	2	24.53	\$31,429.06	2	24.53	\$32,686.23
3	25.25	\$31,057.50	3	25.25	\$32,351.56	3	25.25	\$33,645.63
4	26.29	\$32,336.70	4	26.29	\$33,684.06	4	26.29	\$35,031.43
5	27.38	\$33,677.40	5	27.38	\$35,080.63	5	27.38	\$36,483.85
6	28.42	\$34,956.60	6	28.42	\$36,413.13	6	28.42	\$37,869.65
7	29.46	\$36,235.80	7	29.46	\$37,745.63	7	29.46	\$39,255.45
8	30.58	\$37,613.40	8	30.58	\$39,180.63	8	30.58	\$40,747.85
9	31.76	\$39,064.80	9	31.76	\$40,692.50	9	31.76	\$42,320.20
10	33.03	\$40,626.90	10	33.03	\$42,319.69	10	33.03	\$44,012.48
11	33.72	\$41,475.60	11	33.72	\$43,203.75	11	33.72	\$44,931.90
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,281.16	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,376.21	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,471.25
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,695.91	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,808.24	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,920.57
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,318.05	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,456.30	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,594.55

Paraprofessional - Signing Aide

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2026-2027			2026-2027			2026-2027		
2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	31.98	\$39,335.40	1	31.98	\$40,974.38	1	31.98	\$42,613.35
2	32.94	\$40,516.20	2	32.94	\$42,204.38	2	32.94	\$43,892.55
3	33.93	\$41,733.90	3	33.93	\$43,472.81	3	33.93	\$45,211.73
4	34.95	\$42,988.50	4	34.95	\$44,779.69	4	34.95	\$46,570.88
5	35.99	\$44,267.70	5	35.99	\$46,112.19	5	35.99	\$47,956.68
6	37.07	\$45,596.10	6	37.07	\$47,495.94	6	37.07	\$49,395.78
7	38.20	\$46,986.00	7	38.20	\$48,943.75	7	38.20	\$50,901.50
8	39.33	\$48,375.90	8	39.33	\$50,391.56	8	39.33	\$52,407.23
9	40.51	\$49,827.30	9	40.51	\$51,903.44	9	40.51	\$53,979.58
10	41.74	\$51,340.20	10	41.74	\$53,479.38	10	41.74	\$55,618.55
11	42.98	\$52,865.40	11	42.98	\$55,068.13	11	42.98	\$57,270.85
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,907.60	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,028.75	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,149.90
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,436.25	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,579.43	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,722.61
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,229.23	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,405.45	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,581.67

ETAA Salary Schedule (SY2027-2028)

Paraprofessional

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2027-2028			2027-2028			2027-2028		
2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	24.31	\$29,901.30	1	24.31	\$31,147.19	1	24.31	\$32,393.08
2	25.02	\$30,774.60	2	25.02	\$32,056.88	2	25.02	\$33,339.15
3	25.76	\$31,684.80	3	25.76	\$33,005.00	3	25.76	\$34,325.20
4	26.82	\$32,988.60	4	26.82	\$34,363.13	4	26.82	\$35,737.65
5	27.93	\$34,353.90	5	27.93	\$35,785.31	5	27.93	\$37,216.73
6	28.99	\$35,657.70	6	28.99	\$37,143.44	6	28.99	\$38,629.18
7	30.05	\$36,961.50	7	30.05	\$38,501.56	7	30.05	\$40,041.63
8	31.19	\$38,363.70	8	31.19	\$39,962.19	8	31.19	\$41,560.68
9	32.40	\$39,852.00	9	32.40	\$41,512.50	9	32.40	\$43,173.00
10	33.69	\$41,438.70	10	33.69	\$43,165.31	10	33.69	\$44,891.93
11	34.39	\$42,299.70	11	34.39	\$44,062.19	11	34.39	\$45,824.68
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,326.48	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,423.42	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,520.36
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,749.48	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,864.04	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,978.60
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,383.98	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,524.98	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,665.97

Paraprofessional - Signing Aide

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2027-2028			2027-2028			2027-2028		
2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	32.62	\$40,122.60	1	32.62	\$41,794.38	1	32.62	\$43,466.15
2	33.60	\$41,328.00	2	33.60	\$43,050.00	2	33.60	\$44,772.00
3	34.61	\$42,570.30	3	34.61	\$44,344.06	3	34.61	\$46,117.83
4	35.65	\$43,849.50	4	35.65	\$45,676.56	4	35.65	\$47,503.63
5	36.71	\$45,153.30	5	36.71	\$47,034.69	5	36.71	\$48,916.08
6	37.81	\$46,506.30	6	37.81	\$48,444.06	6	37.81	\$50,381.83
7	38.96	\$47,920.80	7	38.96	\$49,917.50	7	38.96	\$51,914.20
8	40.12	\$49,347.60	8	40.12	\$51,403.75	8	40.12	\$53,459.90
9	41.32	\$50,823.60	9	41.32	\$52,941.25	9	41.32	\$55,058.90
10	42.57	\$52,361.10	10	42.57	\$54,542.81	10	42.57	\$56,724.53
11	43.84	\$53,923.20	11	43.84	\$56,170.00	11	43.84	\$58,416.80
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,965.78	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,089.35	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,212.92
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,505.01	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,651.05	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,797.09
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,313.86	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,493.60	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,673.34

ETAA Salary Schedule (SY2028-2029)

Paraprofessional

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2028-2029			2028-2029			2028-2029		
2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	24.80	\$30,504.00	1	24.80	\$31,775.00	1	24.80	\$33,046.00
2	25.52	\$31,389.60	2	25.52	\$32,697.50	2	25.52	\$34,005.40
3	26.28	\$32,324.40	3	26.28	\$33,671.25	3	26.28	\$35,018.10
4	27.36	\$33,652.80	4	27.36	\$35,055.00	4	27.36	\$36,457.20
5	28.49	\$35,042.70	5	28.49	\$36,502.81	5	28.49	\$37,962.93
6	29.57	\$36,371.10	6	29.57	\$37,886.56	6	29.57	\$39,402.03
7	30.65	\$37,699.50	7	30.65	\$39,270.31	7	30.65	\$40,841.13
8	31.81	\$39,126.30	8	31.81	\$40,756.56	8	31.81	\$42,386.83
9	33.05	\$40,651.50	9	33.05	\$42,345.31	9	33.05	\$44,039.13
10	34.36	\$42,262.80	10	34.36	\$44,023.75	10	34.36	\$45,784.70
11	35.08	\$43,148.40	11	35.08	\$44,946.25	11	35.08	\$46,744.10
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,373.16	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,472.04	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$2,570.93
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,804.65	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$2,921.51	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,038.37
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,451.87	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,595.70	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$3,739.53

Paraprofessional - Signing Aides

Elementary & ECC (6 Hours)			Magnet (6.25 Hours)			Middle (6.5 Hours)		
2028-2029			2028-2029			2028-2029		
2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step			2.0% Increase plus step		
STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary	STEPS	Hourly Rate	Annual Salary
1	33.27	\$40,922.10	1	33.27	\$42,627.19	1	33.27	\$44,332.28
2	34.27	\$42,152.10	2	34.27	\$43,908.44	2	34.27	\$45,664.78
3	35.30	\$43,419.00	3	35.30	\$45,228.13	3	35.30	\$47,037.25
4	36.36	\$44,722.80	4	36.36	\$46,586.25	4	36.36	\$48,449.70
5	37.44	\$46,051.20	5	37.44	\$47,970.00	5	37.44	\$49,888.80
6	38.57	\$47,441.10	6	38.57	\$49,417.81	6	38.57	\$51,394.53
7	39.74	\$48,880.20	7	39.74	\$50,916.88	7	39.74	\$52,953.55
8	40.92	\$50,331.60	8	40.92	\$52,428.75	8	40.92	\$54,525.90
9	42.15	\$51,844.50	9	42.15	\$54,004.69	9	42.15	\$56,164.88
10	43.42	\$53,406.60	10	43.42	\$55,631.88	10	43.42	\$57,857.15
11	44.72	\$55,005.60	11	44.72	\$57,297.50	11	44.72	\$59,589.40
Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,025.31	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,151.36	Top Step Years 2-7	5.5%	\$3,277.42
Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,575.36	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,724.34	Top Step Years 8-15	6.5%	\$3,873.31
Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,400.45	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,583.80	Top Step Years 16+	8.0%	\$4,767.15